

blog focused. In fact, you get the license to be random only when you're famous enough!

We now come to the idea of style. There are three important points here: decide on one initially, develop it, and stick to it.

Just like we said the content of your blog should go with the design, your style, too, should go with the content. You don't want a philosophical or preachy tone on a technology blog. You don't want a serious tone on a blog about your dreams. And so on. Second, you should know that your style will develop over time—so it's a good idea to do a trial run before actually setting up your permanent blog. Blog with all seriousness on this “trial” blog, then critically appraise it yourself. Ask friends what they think of it, whether it reflects you, and whether it's in keeping with the content. Most importantly, ask yourself whether *you* would come back to a blog like yours!

The third point here is about sticking to your style. Most writers have a style. Consider a novel author. His style might vary somewhat across books, but within a book, you'll seldom see the style varying. The reason it shouldn't is, again, about readers' expectations: they get into a certain “mood” when reading something you've written. That mood should be satisfied, as it were.

Style must be consistent within single posts, as well as across your posts. We can't emphasise this enough: style creates identity, and your identity is, of course, what separates you from other bloggers writing about things similar to what you're writing about. Naturally, this isn't the place to discuss how to develop a style—there are many good books out there that can help you with that. Ditto for structure—you'll just need to practise.

We'll give you two examples, though: one of improper structure and one of inconsistent style. Take the following paragraph, from <http://www.island-of-freedom.com/schopen.htm>.